

Michael Fortman

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Work Experience

IBM (formerly DataStax) Remote

March 2021 - Present

Langflow - Lead Frontend Engineer (React, Next.js, Python)

- Led a frontend team of 5 engineers delivering Langflow to production for enterprise customers, partnering closely with design to set craft standards across the platform
- Spearheaded a full platform redesign of Langflow, rebuilding information architecture, interaction patterns, and visual language to transform a fragmented tool into a cohesive, modern developer experience. Featured on stage at NVIDIA GTC
- Revamped rendering performance on the React Flow canvas, eliminating unnecessary rerenders for a ~40% improvement in interaction latency
- Grew Langflow from ~20k to over 140k GitHub stars, making it one of the most widely adopted open source AI projects on GitHub
- Built OpenRAG, an open source platform for building agentic RAG systems, orchestrating containerized services including Langflow, OpenSearch, and Docling. Launched on IBM's watsonx.data platform

Gen AI & Ecosystems - Senior Software Engineer (TS, Vector Search, LangChain, LlamaIndex)

- Sole engineer owning OSS integrations of Astra DB vector search across Vercel, LangChain, and LlamaIndex
- Authored and maintained vector store integrations and starter templates across the GenAI ecosystem
- Built a GitHub Copilot extension letting developers query and manage Astra DB collections, as one of 12 launch partners featured at the Microsoft Build keynote

Astra Streaming - Software Engineer (React, GraphQL, Apache Pulsar)

- Lead frontend engineer taking Astra Streaming from alpha to general availability
- Built a configuration framework powering the UI for 50+ Pulsar connectors, and supported production on-call rotation for both Astra DB and Astra Streaming

Michaels Dallas, TX

August 2020 - March 2021

Michaels.com - Frontend Engineer II (React, D3)

- Greenfield developer creating a brand new Michaels.com including an Etsy-like sellers' platform
- Built a design system and led data visualization engineering using D3 for seller reporting tools

Capital One Dallas, TX

July 2017 - August 2020

Dealer Navigator - Frontend Engineer (Angular, Node, AWS)

- Led and mentored a team of 2-3 contractors to deliver a new design system and component library, ensuring responsive, pixel-perfect, and accessible implementations across the platform
- Served as Lead Frontend Engineer on Dealer Navigator's mobile-first intake tool, partnering with design from ideation through implementation
- Architected and launched a suite of microservice applications for the DFW market, modernizing legacy monolithic systems. Awarded the organization's Diamond Award for speed and quality of development

Education and Certifications

University of Wisconsin-Madison (May 2017)

B.S. Computer Engineering and Computer Sciences Double Major

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

Technical Skills

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular, TypeScript, Tailwind, D3

Backend: Python, Node, GraphQL

AI & ML: MCP, RAG, Vector Databases, Agentic Workflows, LangChain, LlamaIndex

Infrastructure: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions